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Functional Skills Level 2 English Writing Sample Paper 4

Worked Example – good pass

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Sample Paper 4 Level 2 Worked Example – Good Pass

Question 1

One flight from London to South Africa produces as much pollution as each passenger heating their own home for a whole year. Aircraft fuel is one of the biggest causes of global warming and climate change.

Should we reduce the amount we fly?
Should we only take holidays in the UK?
Should the price of plane tickets go up to stop so many people flying?
Are people's rights to have a holiday abroad more important than the planet?

Your task: write an article for a student magazine exploring the issue of so many people flying abroad for holidays and the pollution it causes.

Suggested word count 250 – 300 words.

(27 marks)

The Cost of Flying

Did you know that one flight from London to South Africa produces as much pollution as each passenger heating their own home for a whole year? Just think about that for a moment! And then think about the number of planes that take off and land eachday from all the UKs airports, every single day of the year and the next year and the next. And then concider the number of airports there are in the world and all the daily flights. No wonder our planet is heating up and is in danger. The amount of pollution caused by flying is terrible.

What is the answer? The simple one is that people should reduce the amount they fly or stop flying all together. But is it that simple? Many people only fly once a year. Should they really give up that flight when some buisness people fly every single week! Should buisness be the ones' who cut down on flying?

One part of the problem is definately the fact that you can fly to europe for as little as £1! That has to be wrong. How can people resist the temptation to visit a foren country when flights are so cheep? Perhaps there should be a minimum price for a plane ticket so that it is expensive to fly but that gives an advantage to rich

Sample Paper 4 Level 2 Worked Example – Good Pass

people and stops hard-working familys who don't have as much money from flying which doesn't seem very fair. Why should only rich people be allowed to have a holiday abroad. Surely everyone has the same right to travel.

From my own point of view, I feel that if I don't do some thing about it I am part of the problem so I am going to take my holidays in the UK for the next 3 years. The UK is a fantastic place with so much to explore and discover. As long as you pack for all kinds of wether, you are sure to have a good time. And you can turn that heating on a little bit earlier in the year because you know you haven't taken a flight to South Africa!

Question 1	**Band 4**	**Band 3**	**Band 2**	**Band 1**	
	Consistently	**Most of the time**	**Some of the time**	**Limited**	
Communicates information, ideas and opinions clearly, coherently and effectively	✓				
Writes text of appropriate detail and length	✓				
Uses appropriate format and structure and paragraphing	✓				
Conveys clear meaning and establishes cohesion	✓				
Uses language and register appropriate to audience and purpose	✓				
Constructs complex sentences	✓				
Overall band	Band 4				
Composition Marks	(12-15)	(8-11)	(4-7)	(0-3)	15

Question 1	**Consistently accurate at appropriate level 4 marks**	**Accurate most of the time 3 marks**	**Accurate some of the time 2 marks**	**Limited accuracy 1 mark**	**Insufficient evidence 0 marks**	
Spelling		3				
Punctuation		3				
Grammar	4					
SPaG Total						10
SPaG mark + composition mark						25

Sample Paper 4 Level 2 Worked Example – Good Pass

Commentary

Composition

This is a very good response that consistently meets all the composition standards, therefore receiving the top mark available.

Spelling, punctuation and grammar

There are some spelling errors. The vast majority of the spelling is correct, but there are at least eight errors.

Punctuation is also correct most of the time, and there is evidence of punctuation use that goes beyond sentence demarcation. However, there are errors with some of the apostrophes, the capital letters for proper nouns and some commas to separate clauses. In addition, the occasional question mark has been omitted.

Grammar is well controlled throughout.

Sample Paper 4 Level 2 Worked Example – Good Pass

Question 2

Your work placement in the marketing department at a theme park has come to an end.

Your task: write a formal letter to the manager of the marketing department to thank them for the experience.

You could cover:

- thanking the manager and the team
- what you found valuable
- which parts you particularly enjoyed
- suggestions to improve the experience for the next work placement candidate
- your goals for your future career.

The person to write to is: Ms Holly Stephens, Marketing Manager, Lakeside Theme Park, Highfield Road, Cranshire, CR6 9JL

Write 5 – 6 paragraphs.

(27 marks)

Mrs Holly Stevens
Marketing Manager
Lakeside Theme Park
Highfield Road
Cranshire
CR6 9JL

Dear Mrs Stevens

I just wanted to write to say thank you for giving me the opportunity to complete my work experience in your department. I enjoyed it so much and felt that I learnt a lot too. I hope you can pass on my thanks to the rest of the team too because every one was so helpful and encouraging and made me feel part of the team straight away.

All the tasks I was given were interesting. I especially enjoyed having to keep an eye on all our social media platform's and responding to the various comments and messages we received. I had no idea when I first arrived that the theme park uses social media so much for marketing.

Sample Paper 4 Level 2 Worked Example – Good Pass

Of all the tasks I was given what I found really valuable was having to write the weekly newsletter for the website. Not only did it help me learn about managing the content on a website it also really helped me sharpen up my writing skills.

So thank you once again for the opportunity, it has confirmed for me that marketing is something I would like to do. Please pass my thanks on to the team.

Yours faithfully

Olivia Graham

Question 2	**Band 4**	**Band 3**	**Band 2**	**Band 1**	
	Consistently	**Most of the time**	**Some of the time**	**Limited**	
Communicates information, ideas and opinions clearly, coherently and effectively	✓				
Writes text of appropriate detail and length			✓		
Uses appropriate format and structure and paragraphing		✓			
Conveys clear meaning and establishes cohesion	✓				
Uses language and register appropriate to audience and purpose	✓				
Constructs complex sentences	✓				
Overall band	Band 4				
Composition Marks	(12-15)	(8-11)	(4-7)	(0-3)	12

Sample Paper 4 Level 2 Worked Example – Good Pass

Question 2	**Consistently accurate at appropriate level 4 marks**	**Accurate most of the time 3 marks**	**Accurate some of the time 2 marks**	**Limited accuracy 1 mark**	**Insufficient evidence 0 marks**	
Spelling	4					
Punctuation				1		
Grammar	4					
SPaG Total						9
SPaG mark + composition mark						21

Overall mark for question 1	25
Overall mark for question 2	21
FINAL MARK	46

Commentary

Composition

Most of the composition elements are strong. Unfortunately, the candidate has omitted their own address and used an incorrect valediction for a formal letter, so format and structure marks are affected. The candidate has also omitted to talk about the last two bullet points in the question brief, so detail marks are affected. Language and the use of complex sentences are both strong throughout and cohesion is established through clear links between sentences and paragraphs.

Spelling, punctuation and grammar

Spelling is almost faultless, and there is good evidence of ambitious words being used, such as *opportunity* and *encouraging*.

Punctuation was weaker. Sentence demarcation is mostly correct although there is a comma splice in the last paragraph, and there are several instances where commas should have been used to separate clauses. The single use of an apostrophe is also incorrect.

Grammar is consistently correct throughout.

Sample Paper 4 Level 2 Worked Example – Borderline Script

Question 1

One flight from London to South Africa produces as much pollution as each passenger heating their own home for a whole year. Aircraft fuel is one of the biggest causes of global warming and climate change.

Should we reduce the amount we fly?
Should we only take holidays in the UK?
Should the price of plane tickets go up to stop so many people flying?
Are people's rights to have a holiday abroad more important than the planet?

Your task: write an article for a student magazine exploring the issue of so many people flying abroad for holidays and the pollution it causes.

Suggested word count 250 – 300 words.

(27 marks)

Air travel and Pollution

I was really surprise to read that airplanes cause so much pollution. It has made me think about all the people catching plane rides all over the world and wether we should be doing this all the time or not. We have only one planet and if we don't look after it we do not have another one to go to. Air pollution is really bad for everyone and planes cause most of it. If we all stoped flying then the air will be cleaner and everyone can breath better. If we did all stop flying everyone would have to take there holidays in the uk unless they drive to other countries. But if everyone drives there cars then that will also create lost of pollution. The best thing is to take hoildays in England, Scotland, Wales or northern Ireland, however that would be sad because there are so many good places abroad and often the wether is much more better. The price of plane tickets should go up because this will stop so many flights for richer people and then the people who dont have as much money will be able to go on holiday. This would then mean all the prices would be lower than usual. And at the end of the day I dont think we can stop people flying because it is there right to be able to travel abroad. We just need to think about it and perhaps take less flights. Its your choice – flying or the planet.

Sample Paper 4 Level 2 Worked Example – Borderline Script

Question 1	**Band 4**	**Band 3**	**Band 2**	**Band 1**	
	Consistently	**Most of the time**	**Some of the time**	**Limited**	
Communicates information, ideas and opinions clearly, coherently and effectively		✓			
Writes text of appropriate detail and length		✓			
Uses appropriate format and structure and paragraphing			✓		
Conveys clear meaning and establishes cohesion		✓			
Uses language and register appropriate to audience and purpose		✓			
Constructs complex sentences		✓			
Overall band	Band 3				
Composition Marks	(12-15)	(8-11)	(4-7)	(0-3)	11

Question 1	**Consistently accurate at appropriate level** **4 marks**	**Accurate most of the time** **3 marks**	**Accurate some of the time** **2 marks**	**Limited accuracy** **1 mark**	**Insufficient evidence** **0 marks**	
Spelling		3				
Punctuation				2		
Grammar		3				
SPaG Total						8
SPaG mark + composition mark						19

Sample Paper 4 Level 2 Worked Example – Borderline Script

Commentary

The format and structure elements of an article are present, namely a title, an introduction and an attempt to bring the article to a conclusion. However, paragraphing is not present. There is also a lack of clarity in the second half regarding the prices charged for plane tickets and who will subsequently travel. All the required detail is there, and the length is appropriate for the task and the audience. Language choice is relatively simple, and there are some incorrect or clumsy expressions, for instance *catching plane rides*, *is much more better* and *less flights*.

Composition

Spelling, punctuation and grammar

Spelling errors include *breathe, whether, stopped, holidays, weather, lots, perhaps*.

Punctuation errors include omitted commas, lower case letters on proper nouns and initials, a comma splice and some missing apostrophes in contractions. However, there is evidence of correct use of apostrophes in some of the contractions, commas to separate items in a list and correct capitalisation of some proper nouns.

Grammar is generally correct. However, there is some inconsistency of tense use within sentences. For example, *If we all stopped flying then the air will be cleaner and everyone can breath better.* In addition, there are errors in verb-tense agreement and the incorrect form of *there/their*.

Sample Paper 4 Level 2 Worked Example – Borderline Script

Question 2

Your work placement in the marketing department at a theme park has come to an end.

Your task: write a formal letter to the manager of the marketing department to thank them for the experience.

You could cover:

- thanking the manager and the team
- what you found valuable
- which parts you particularly enjoyed
- suggestions to improve the experience for the next work placement candidate
- your goals for your future career.

The person to write to is: Ms Holly Stephens, Marketing Manager, Lakeside Theme Park, Highfield Road, Cranshire, CR6 9JL

Write 5 – 6 paragraphs.

(27 marks)

Sample Paper 4 Level 2 Worked Example – Borderline Script

Marheting Manager
Lakeside theme park
Highfield road
Cranshire
Cr6 9jL

Eddie Wild
8 Richards road
Cranshire
Cr2 8Hg

Dear Mrs Stevens

I am writing just to say a big thankyou to you and the whole team for making my work placement such a great experience. I know it has helped me alot and I feel I have learned many things that I would not of learned if I just stayed at college.

The bit I enjoyed the most was when we all got to go on the rides on the friday afternoon. Most of the work was very enjoyable aswell a part from the time when I had to deal with the angry costumer, however this did teach me a good lesson which was to allways keep carm when dealing with a customer.

Suggestions to improve it for the next work placement is to prehaps let them do some of the selling of the tickets in the ticket office because that is an impotant part of it all.

My goals in the future is to finish my course at collage and then try to find a job in marketing.

Your faithfully

Eddie Wild

Sample Paper 4 Level 2 Worked Example – Borderline Script

Question 2	**Band 4**	**Band 3**	**Band 2**	**Band 1**	
	Consistently	**Most of the time**	**Some of the time**	**Limited**	
Communicates information, ideas and opinions clearly, coherently and effectively			✓		
Writes text of appropriate detail and length		✓			
Uses appropriate format and structure and paragraphing			✓		
Conveys clear meaning and establishes cohesion			✓		
Uses language and register appropriate to audience and purpose		✓			
Constructs complex sentences		✓			
Overall band	Band 3				
Composition Marks	(12-15)	(8-11)	(4-7)	(0-3)	9

Question 2	**Consistently accurate at appropriate level 4 marks**	**Accurate most of the time 3 marks**	**Accurate some of the time 2 marks**	**Limited accuracy 1 mark**	**Insufficient evidence 0 marks**	
Spelling			2			
Punctuation				1		
Grammar		3				
SPaG Total						6
SPaG mark + composition mark						15

Overall mark for question 1	19
Overall mark for question 2	15
FINAL MARK	34

Sample Paper 4 Level 2 Worked Example – Borderline Script

Commentary

In terms of format and structure the candidate has several errors in the layout of the letter. The recipient's and sender's addresses are in the wrong order, there is no date and the valediction does not match the salutation. Most of the detail has been covered, although the response does not specify which parts of the work experience were found to be valuable. In addressing the other bullet points, there is a sense that the candidate has not given much thought or planning time to establishing cohesion, thus adding to the coherence of the whole, but is merely addressing the bullet points as individual subjects that need to be covered. The rather abrupt end reinforces this feeling.

Composition

Spelling, punctuation and grammar

Spelling errors include *marketing, thank you, a lot, as well, apart, customer, always, calm, perhaps, important,* and *college*.

Punctuation errors include omitted commas to separate clauses, lower case letters on proper nouns and a comma splice. Some sentence demarcation is correct.

Grammar is generally correct, but there are some errors, including the use of *not of*, inconsistency of tense use within a sentence, incorrect form of *there/their*, the occasional subject-verb errors and *your* instead of *yours*.

Sample Paper 4 Level 2 Worked Example - Fail

Question 1

One flight from London to South Africa produces as much pollution as each passenger heating their own home for a whole year. Aircraft fuel is one of the biggest causes of global warming and climate change.

Should we reduce the amount we fly?
Should we only take holidays in the UK?
Should the price of plane tickets go up to stop so many people flying?
Are people's rights to have a holiday abroad more important than the planet?

Your task: write an article for a student magazine exploring the issue of so many people flying abroad for holidays and the pollution it causes.

Suggested word count 250 – 300 words.

(27 marks)

- Should we reduce the amount we fly

We shouldnt reduce the amount we fly because is important that people can go where they want in the world. If I have holiday time I want to go abroad and fly.

- Should we only holiday in the UK

No. This is unfair. I dont want to have holiday in UK because whether is no good all of the time in summer.

- Should the price of plane ticket go up to stop so many people flying

No. I dont think the price they should go up, this is unfair to all people who do not have much money to spend. They should still be aloud to fly on holiday.

- Are peoples rights to have a holiday abroad more important then the planet?

Sample Paper 4 Level 2 Worked Example - Fail

No. The planet is important and if we not did have good planet we will have all die. We should protect the planet in ever way posible and if that mean we can not go holiday we have to stay at home

Question 1	**Band 4**	**Band 3**	**Band 2**	**Band 1**	
	Consistently	**Most of the time**	**Some of the time**	**Limited**	
Communicates information, ideas and opinions clearly, coherently and effectively				✓	
Writes text of appropriate detail and length			✓		
Uses appropriate format and structure and paragraphing			✓		
Conveys clear meaning and establishes cohesion			✓		
Uses language and register appropriate to audience and purpose				✓	
Constructs complex sentences			✓		
Overall band	Band 2				
Composition Marks	(12-15)	(8-11)	(4-7)	(0-3)	5

Question 1	**Consistently accurate at appropriate level** **4 marks**	**Accurate most of the time** **3 marks**	**Accurate some of the time** **2 marks**	**Limited accuracy** **1 mark**	**Insufficient evidence** **0 marks**	
Spelling			2			
Punctuation				1		
Grammar				1		
SPaG Total						4
SPaG mark + composition mark						9

Sample Paper 4 Level 2 Worked Example - Fail

Commentary

Composition

Coherence and cohesion are particularly weak in this response. The candidate has not thought about the purpose of the article or the audience. They have simply addressed each bullet point in turn, providing no context for the reader as to why the article is being written. There is an inconsistency in the message in the final paragraph, which creates confusion, and it then becomes unclear what the writer's point of view is. Although there has been an attempt to format and structure the response through using bullet points and repeating the question prompts, the main essential element to an article, a title, is missing. An attempt has been made to cover each bullet point in the question brief, but each one is responded to with a maximum of two sentences, and the overall length falls short of the suggested 250-300 words.

Spelling, punctuation and grammar

The spelling mark reflects the fact that there are very few ambitious words and several errors in relatively straight forward words, such as *every, weather, cannot, possible, allowed* and *than*.

The punctuation mark is also low due to the many errors. Errors include omitted question marks, omitted apostrophes, omitted commas, at least one comma splice and a lack of a full stop on the last sentence.

There are grammar errors in every section. Articles and other word types are omitted, there are errors regarding verb-tense agreement and some of the word order is incorrect.

Sample Paper 4 Level 2 Worked Example - Fail

Question 2

Your work placement in the marketing department at a theme park has come to an end.

Your task: write a formal letter to the manager of the marketing department to thank them for the experience.

You could cover:

- thanking the manager and the team
- what you found valuable
- which parts you particularly enjoyed
- suggestions to improve the experience for the next work placement candidate
- your goals for your future career.

The person to write to is: Ms Holly Stephens, Marketing Manager, Lakeside Theme Park, Highfield Road, Cranshire, CR6 9JL

Write 5 – 6 paragraphs.

(27 marks)

I am writing to say thanks alot for giving me opportunity to work in marketing department. I enjoyed very much the chances of working with team. I am thanking ever one. I will say that all job was valuable to me specially working with costumers. I am hoping that I will be working for marketing in furture because I enjoyed all parts and I like the team very much who is all very nice people. In furture I will go back to college and study my buisness cause and one day may be I open a theme park like you. May be if to iprove for next person is to give them job in marketing department then they have good experience. Thankyou again. Regards. Ali

Sample Paper 4 Level 2 Worked Example - Fail

Question 2	**Band 4**	**Band 3**	**Band 2**	**Band 1**	
	Consistently	**Most of the time**	**Some of the time**	**Limited**	
Communicates information, ideas and opinions clearly, coherently and effectively			✓		
Writes text of appropriate detail and length			✓		
Uses appropriate format and structure and paragraphing				✓	
Conveys clear meaning and establishes cohesion			✓		
Uses language and register appropriate to audience and purpose			✓		
Constructs complex sentences			✓		
Overall band	Band 2				
Composition Marks	(12-15)	(8-11)	(4-7)	(0-3)	6

Question 2	**Consistently accurate at appropriate level 4 marks**	**Accurate most of the time 3 marks**	**Accurate some of the time 2 marks**	**Limited accuracy 1 mark**	**Insufficient evidence 0 marks**	
Spelling				1		
Punctuation				1		
Grammar					0	
SPaG Total						2
SPaG mark + composition mark						8

Overall mark for question 1	9
Overall mark for question 2	8
FINAL MARK	17

Sample Paper 4 Level 2 Worked Example - Fail

Commentary

Composition

The required components of a formal letter are missing. Presenting a block of text has resulted in a low banding for format, structure and paragraphing. The response is also relatively short. Although there has been an attempt to cover all of the bullet points, expansion upon the points is minimal, and this has been taken into account when allocating marks. Language use is a long way below that which would be expected for a level 2 candidate.

Spelling, punctuation and grammar

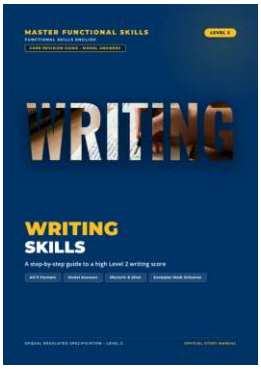
Spelling errors are relatively frequent and include the more ambitious words as well as some simple words. Punctuation is limited to sentence demarcation, and grammar errors are numerous.

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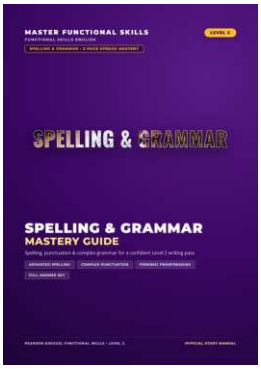


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